

Newsletter Audit

Marketing emails, 1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026 · Source: HubSpot (read-only) · 8 Oct 2026

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HubSpot email health score

HubSpot rating: "Needs work"

3.26%

Click rate

1.03M emails sent

0.81%

Unsubscribe rate

+72% vs previous 12 months

1.29%

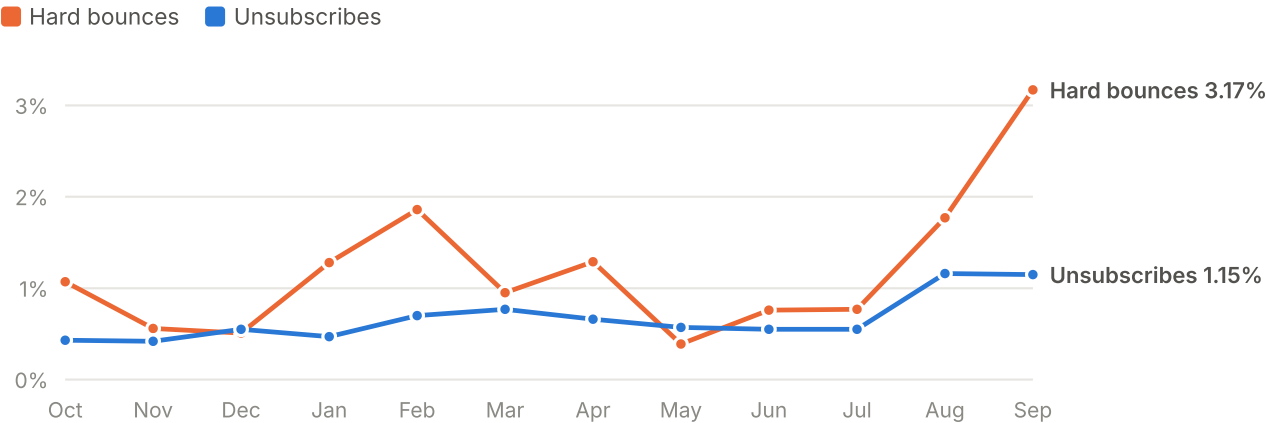
Hard bounce rate

+97% vs previous 12 months

● What's flagged

- Hard bounces: 2.54% in the last 30 days. HubSpot's benchmark is 0.25%.
- Unsubscribes: 1.04% in the last 30 days. HubSpot's benchmark is 0.35%.
- 3 sends in Aug–Sep (Japan Sansan list, Corporate Survey 3rd batch, Alibaba startup email) caused 52% of unsubscribes and 79% of bounces in that period.
- Contact limit: 590,458 marketing contacts, which is 93.7% of the 630,000 tier. 433,657 of them have never opened a marketing email.
- Unsubscribe reasons: no data, because the unsubscribe feedback survey is switched off.
- Reporting by location isn't possible: none of the 1,042 emails has a team assigned.
- Old automations: 65 email workflows are still ON but haven't been updated since before 2024.

Hard bounces and unsubscribes by month (% of delivered emails)



● What's working

Japan newsletter: 9.6% click rate and 0.05% unsubscribes (4 sends, every 2 weeks, its own subscription type).

APAC newsletter: 3.0% click rate, its own subscription type.

Small, targeted emails get high clicks: SV building events, Finland (THF) program emails, mentor and finalist emails.

Spam reports are very low (0.01%) and **98.3% of emails are delivered**.

"Don't send to unengaged contacts" is switched on.

● What can be improved

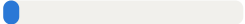
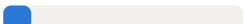
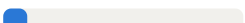
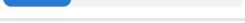
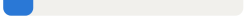
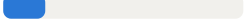
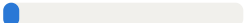
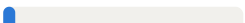
Large newsletters with low clicks and high unsubscribes: UK, Italy and Fintech & AI Insights (see table).

8 location newsletters share one subscription type ("Marketing Communications"), so contacts can't opt out of just one of them.

Few contacts engage: 81,646 of 590,458 marketing contacts opened or clicked an email in the last 12 months.

Subscription types need a tidy-up: 14 active and 81 archived.

Main recurring newsletters (Aug-Sep 2026)

Newsletter	Avg. sent to	Click rate	Unsubscribe rate
Fintech & AI Fund Insights	8,611	 0.7%	1.42%
Italy Newsletter *	6,624	 1.3%	0.96%
UK Newsletter *	6,474	 1.1%	0.98%
Global Newsletter (GNL)	5,748	 2.4%	0.53%
Texas Newsletter *	4,746	 2.9%	0.65%
Startup Autobahn Monthly	4,384	 2.1%	0.34%
Central Asia & Caucasus Latest News *	3,302	 1.5%	0.76%
APAC Newsletter	2,756	 3.0%	0.36%
Seattle Community Newsletter *	1,787	 2.2%	0.56%
Indiana Medtech + Lifetech Newsletter *	1,430	 1.3%	0.56%
Türkiye Newsletter *	1,420	 1.9%	0.56%
Japan Newsletter	989	 9.6%	0.05%
Foundation Newsletter	805	 0.7%	0.99%
Startup Autobahn Alumni Newsletter	612	 0.5%	0.49%
Cyprus Latest News *	309	 10.4%	1.94%

Red = above HubSpot's unsubscribe benchmark (0.35%). * = sent under the shared "Marketing Communications" subscription type.

● Possible next steps

- 1 **Imported lists:** check and clean large imported lists before sending, and send a small test batch first.
- 2 **Unsubscribe survey:** switch it on so we can see why people leave (needs a HubSpot admin).
- 3 **Inactive contacts:** review the 433,657 marketing contacts who have never opened an email, and decide with the manager/admin whether to set them as non-marketing.
- 4 **Subscription types:** give the main location newsletters (UK, Italy, Texas...) their own subscription type, like Japan and APAC.
- 5 **Teams and naming:** assign a team and use one naming format on every email so results can be reported by location.
- 6 **Workflows:** review the 65 old workflows with their owners and switch off the ones no longer needed.
- 7 **Newsletter owners:** confirm who owns each newsletter and how often it's sent.
- 8 **Check again in 90 days:** health score, bounces, unsubscribes and marketing contacts.

Newsletter-level figures are based on the latest 100 of 1,042 emails sent (Aug-Sep 2026). All other figures cover the full 12 months. Full data is in *PNP_HubSpot_Newsletter_Audit.xlsx*.